

だっすい しょくよく すこ の
脱水と食欲：少しずつ飲む

Dehydration & Appetite Loss — Offer, Don't Push, Report the Amount — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Notice the early signs of dehydration and appetite loss: see what was left on the tray, ask about pain, offer fluids little by little as an invitation he can refuse, let him choose the drink, praise the amount he takes, come back at a set time, and report the amount — not an impression.

1・Dialogue & Why — 会話

Hana
(caregiver)

やまだ ひる はんぶん
山田さん、お昼は半分でしたね。

Yamada-san, you had half your lunch today.

Why: Look at the tray before you say anything. Half a lunch left and the tea untouched is where dehydration starts in an older resident — notice it kindly, as a fact.

Yamada-san
(resident)

 しょくよく
あまり食欲がないんです。

I don't have much appetite.

Why: 食欲 is appetite. Losing it can come from pain, a sore mouth, a fever or low mood. You do not guess which — you notice, ask, and pass it on.

Hana
(caregiver)

 いた
どこか痛いですか。

Does anything hurt?

Why: Ask before you offer food again. If something hurts, that changes what comes next — and it goes to the nurse first.

Yamada-san
(resident)

 すこ
いいえ。でも、少しだるいです。

No. But I feel a bit sluggish.

Why: だるい — heavy, tired, sluggish — is easy to wave away. Next to a poor appetite it is one of the quiet signs of 脱水, dehydration. Remember the word.

Hana
(caregiver)

 ちゃ の
お茶は飲みましたか。

Have you had your tea?

Why: Check drinks, not only food. Look at the cup as well as asking — a full cup answers the question more honestly than a polite yes.

Yamada-san
(resident)

 のど かわ
いいえ、喉は渴いていません。

No, I'm not thirsty.

仕事日本語・Shigoto Nihongo

Why: The most common answer, and the reason dehydration is missed. Older people feel thirstless, so 'not thirsty' does not mean 'had enough'. Accept it, and still offer.

Free video lessons on YouTube: [JLPT N4-26: dehydration; appetite](#)

Hana
(caregiver)

すこ
の
少しずつ 飲みませんか。

How about drinking a little at a time?

Why: THE RULE OF THIS EPISODE, first half. Offer, do not push. ～ませんか invites him and leaves him free to say no; small sips, often, do more than one big cup.

Yamada-san
(resident)

つめ
ちゃ
の
冷たい お茶なら、飲めます。

If it's cold tea, I can drink that.

Why: Now you know what he will take. Cold or warm, tea or water — the choice is his, and a drink he likes is a drink he finishes.

Hana
(caregiver)

つめ
ちゃ
も
では、冷たい お茶を お持ちしますね。

Then I'll bring you some cold tea.

Why: お持ちします is the humble 'I'll bring it' (Ep 3). Follow his choice straight away — it shows him the choice was real.

Hana
(caregiver)

ひとくち
だいじょうぶ
一口だけでも 大丈夫ですよ。

Even just one sip is fine.

Why: THE RULE, second half. Lower the bar. A resident told one sip counts will often take three; one told to finish the cup often takes none.

Yamada-san
(resident)

ああ、おいしいです。

Ah, that's nice.

Why: Let him drink at his own pace, sitting upright (Ep 3). Do not refill the cup the moment he puts it down.

Hana
(caregiver)

はんぶん
の
コップ 半分 飲めましたね。

You managed half a cup.

Why: Look at the cup and say the amount out loud, warmly. It praises him, and it fixes the number in your head for the report.

Yamada-san
(resident)

すこ
の
もう 少し あとで 飲みます。

I'll have a bit more later.

Why: He is setting his own pace, and that is fine. Your job is to make 'later' real — by coming back, not by hoping he remembers.

Hana
(caregiver)

じ
き
3時に また 来ますね。

I'll come back at three.

Why: Name a time and keep it. Small drinks spread across the afternoon are how dehydration is prevented — and a promise kept is why he says yes next time.

Hana
(caregiver)

だるいことは、^{かんごし}看護師に^{つた}伝えますね。

I'll tell the nurse that you feel sluggish.

Why: A poor appetite plus だるい goes to the nurse today, not tomorrow — it can be the start of a fever or dehydration. Say it calmly, so it does not frighten him.

Hana
(caregiver)

^{ちゃ}お茶は^{はんぶん}半分と^{ほうこく}報告します。

I'll report it: half a cup of tea.

Why: Report an AMOUNT, never 'he drank some'. Half a lunch, half a cup, sluggish all afternoon — three facts the nurse can act on, written down the same way by every shift.

2・Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES
1	^{はんぶん} 半分	hanbun	half	
2	^{しょくよく} 食欲	shokuyoku	appetite	
3	^{いた} 痛い	itai	painful; it hurts (recycled from Ep 25)	
4	だるい	darui	sluggish; heavy and tired	
5	^の 飲む	nomu	to drink	
6	^{のど} 喉	nodo	throat	
7	^{かわ} 渴く	kawaku	to be thirsty (of the throat)	
8	^{すこ} 少しずつ	sukoshizutsu	little by little	
9	^{つめ} 冷たい	tsumetai	cold (to the touch)	
10	^も 持つ	motsu	to hold; bring	
11	^{ひとくち} 一口	hitokuchi	one mouthful; one sip	
12	^{だいじょうぶ} 大丈夫	daijoubu	okay; all right (recycled from Ep 24)	
13	仕事日本語・Shigoto Nihongo	koppu	cup, glass	Free video lesson on YouTube・ks-26-dehydration-appetite

14	くる	<i>kuru</i>	to come	
15	看護師	<i>kangoshi</i>	nurse (recycled from Ep 25)	
16	伝える	<i>tsutaeru</i>	to tell; pass on (recycled from Ep 25)	
17	報告する	<i>houkokusuru</i>	to report (recycled from Ep 25)	

3・Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE
すこ ^の 少しずつ 飲みませんか	Offer a drink — invite, never order
ひとくち ^{だいじょうぶ} 一口だけでも 大丈夫ですよ	Lower the bar so he can start
コップ ^{はんぶん} の 半分 飲みましたね	Notice the amount and praise it
じ ^き 3時に また 来ますね	Make 'later' a real time, then keep it
ちゃ ^{はんぶん} お茶は 半分と 報告しま す	Report an amount, never 'some'

4・Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	What does Yamada-san say at the start? A) あまり 食欲がないんです B) 喉が渴きました C) 熱があります D) よく 聞こえません	
2	What can Yamada-san drink? A) お水 B) 冷たい お茶 C) ジュース D) 何も 飲みません	
3	Invite him to drink a little at a time.	
4	Tell him even just one sip is fine. 仕事日本語・Shigoto Nihongo	
5	Say you'll report half a cup of tea.	

5・Answer Key — こたえ

1. あまり 食欲しょくよくがないんです。

2. 冷つめたい お茶ちゃなら、飲のめます。

3. 少すこしずつ 飲のみませんか。

4. 一ひと口くちだけでも 大だい丈じょう夫ぶですよ。

5. お茶ちゃは 半はん分ぶんと 報ほう告こくします。